WATCHMEN ON THE WALL — TODAY'S WATCH

Tuesday, October 13, 2026

INDEX

1. UPDATE — Saudi Arabia probes air-defense failure as airport toll reaches at least 18 — WELL-CORROBORATED After four Riyadh airport attacks, Saudi investigators are examining how drones and maneuvering missiles penetrated defenses while the airport remains closed and allied airlines withdraw service.

2. Drone attacks sink a cargo ship off Bulgaria; 11 sailors missing — WELL-CORROBORATED Two merchant vessels were struck beside NATO member Bulgaria, prompting an emergency security meeting, a Russian diplomatic summons and requests for stronger NATO and EU maritime surveillance.

3. UPDATE — Russia pauses energy strikes for one night but continues deadly bombardment — WELL-CORROBORATED Russia avoided confirmed Ukrainian energy targets for the first time since President Trump's claimed truce, while missiles and drones still killed four people and damaged transport, logistics and a hospital.

1. UPDATE — Saudi Arabia probes air-defense failure as airport toll reaches at least 18

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Saudi Arabia opened an investigation into how its defenses failed to stop a coordinated Houthi attack on King Khalid International Airport. Regional officials told the Associated Press that drones were used first, followed by cruise and ballistic missiles—including maneuvering warheads capable of challenging Patriot interceptors.

Saudi forces intercepted two more ballistic missiles aimed toward Riyadh on Monday. Reuters reported that four airport attacks during the preceding week killed at least 18 people and wounded more than 300. Public attack alerts had stopped after September 29 and resumed Monday; Saudi officials had not publicly explained the interruption. Associated Press, Reuters on the warning system and Reuters on Monday's interception.

The airport is scheduled to remain closed until October 17. Air France–KLM extended its suspension through October, while numerous Asian, European, Gulf and American airlines canceled or delayed Saudi routes. Reuters airline tracker.

What changed: The issue has moved beyond casualty updates: Saudi authorities are investigating systemic defense and warning failures, the verified weekly death toll has risen, new missiles continue toward Riyadh and international aviation disruption is extending for weeks or months.

Prophetic relevance: An Iran-aligned force has demonstrated sustained reach against the capital of a major regional power while Saudi Arabia seeks greater U.S. and allied protection. This is a serious multinational-war development, but it remains directed at Saudi Arabia rather than the Israel-centered invasion described in Ezekiel 38.

Scripture watch: Ezekiel 38:5–13; Daniel 11; Matthew 24:6–8.

2. Drone attacks sink a cargo ship off Bulgaria; 11 sailors missing

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Bulgarian officials said drones struck two merchant ships near the country's Black Sea coast. The Guinea-Bissau-flagged HS Dignity sank; five sailors were rescued and 11 remained missing. Three drones struck the Maltese-flagged, Ukrainian-operated Chelsea 3; all 15 crew members were evacuated and five received treatment.

Bulgaria convened an emergency Security Council meeting, summoned Russia's ambassador and requested stronger NATO and EU maritime and air surveillance. The European Commission and Ukraine attributed the escalation to Russia, but Bulgarian authorities said they did not yet possess clear evidence identifying the attacker; Russia's ambassador suggested a possible third-party provocation. Bulgarian government statement, Reuters and Associated Press.

What changed: This is the second deadly commercial-shipping episode in Bulgaria's maritime zone within a week, but the first to sink a ship with 11 people missing while drawing an emergency NATO-member security response.

Prophetic relevance: The Russia–Ukraine war is expanding geographically into commercial shipping near NATO waters and routes important to global grain supplies. The event does not establish Russia as Gog and the attacker's identity remains unresolved.

Scripture watch: Matthew 24:6–7; Luke 21:9–10; Ezekiel 38:1–9.

3. UPDATE — Russia pauses energy strikes for one night but continues deadly bombardment

CONFIDENCE: WELL-CORROBORATED

Verified facts: Russia's overnight attack into Tuesday included six ballistic missiles and 108 drones but no confirmed strike on Ukrainian energy infrastructure—the first such night since President Trump announced an "energy ceasefire." Ukraine also reported no refinery attacks against Russia for a second night.

Russia still had not publicly acknowledged joining the ceasefire, and a missile landed slightly more than one kilometer from a Lviv heating plant. Russian attacks killed four people in Kharkiv and damaged transport, logistics, residential sites and a hospital across 17 locations. Reuters.

What changed: Monday's report documented Russian strikes immediately after the claimed truce. Tuesday brought the first observable one-night pause in confirmed energy targeting, but no formal Russian commitment or broader halt to lethal attacks.

Prophetic relevance: Even limited restraint negotiated by a powerful intermediary merits attention, but this remains an unconfirmed sector-specific pause rather than Daniel 9:27's covenant involving Israel. Continued bombardment also underscores that no general peace exists.

Scripture watch: Daniel 9:27; Matthew 24:6–7; Ezekiel 38:1–9.

JEWISH CALENDAR — NEXT 7 DAYS

Friday evening–Saturday, October 16–17 — Shabbat Noach: Jerusalem candle lighting is 5:26 PM Friday, following the local 40-minutes-before-sunset custom. Standard Havdalah is 6:41 PM Saturday; a 42-minute convention gives 6:47 PM, while later customs vary. The reading is Genesis 6:9–11:32, covering the Flood, God's covenant with Noah and Babel.

No major Jewish festival or fast falls during October 13–19. Jewish days begin at sunset; candle lighting precedes sunset, while Havdalah follows halachic nightfall and varies by convention. Hebcal Jerusalem calendar.

SIGNS & ANNIVERSARY WATCH

October 16–17 — Lunar apogee: The Moon reaches the farthest portion of its monthly orbit around this period; published ephemerides differ slightly on the exact instant. This is a routine orbital event.

October 18 at approximately 16:12 UTC — 12:12 PM Eastern: The Moon reaches first quarter. No solar or lunar eclipse occurs during the next seven days. The Orionid meteor shower peaks after this window, overnight October 21–22. Assessment: astronomically routine; no demonstrated prophetic significance. NASA GSFC Sky Events Calendar, NASA October skywatching and Timeanddate lunar phases.

Modern State of Israel: Established May 14, 1948 — 78 years ago.

Jerusalem: Israel captured East Jerusalem and the Old City during the June 1967 Six-Day War — 59 years ago.

Neither reaches a new yearly anniversary this week. The establishment of the State of Israel and Israel's later capture of East Jerusalem are distinct historical events; Jerusalem is a city, not a nation.

ANTICHRIST WATCH — BIBLICAL TRAITS, NOT ACCUSATIONS

No new candidate-relevant development.

This is a watchlist of documented traits and developments, not identification of any living person as the Antichrist. Relevant markers include extraordinary ascent and authority, a pivotal covenant involving Israel, exceptional political-military power, self-exaltation, blasphemy and persecution.

Key passages: Daniel 7; Daniel 9:27; Daniel 11; 2 Thessalonians 2; Revelation 13; 1 John 2.

What to Watch Next

1. Whether Saudi Arabia identifies the specific failures in its Patriot, radar and public-warning systems and requests direct U.S. military involvement.
2. Whether Riyadh airport reopens October 17 or further attacks extend the shutdown and international flight suspensions.
3. Whether rescuers find the 11 missing HS Dignity sailors and whether Bulgaria, NATO or the EU establishes who launched the drones.
4. Whether Russia formally accepts and sustains the energy pause, or Ukraine resumes refinery attacks after another violation.
5. Any material Temple Mount prayer, access, enforcement, Third Temple or red-heifer development.